

“AI (Artificial Intelligence) as a tool of psychological and professional empowerment in the hands of SCBC communities”

AI learning and Empowerment Initiative - Concept Note

A. Context & Opportunity

Direct benefit transfers and financial support schemes, while essential, stop short of enabling long-term self-sufficiency. True welfare lies in building an individual's capacity to identify problems, design solutions, and believe they can lead change. This document presents a proof-of-concept that places AI as a tool of psychological and professional empowerment in the hands of SCBC communities. The lived experience of marginalized communities holds the deepest, most nuanced understanding of real problems. Our program is designed to unlock that knowledge — and translate it into action.

B. Core Philosophy

Empowerment begins when people believe: “I am capable. I can build. I can solve. For myself and others.” Once individuals experience this shift, welfare transforms from support delivery into capability creation.

Beyond Literacy	This is not an AI teaching program. It is a program of psychological empowerment. When individuals from marginalised communities build something real — in their own language, with their own context — they start believing they can. That belief is the most powerful form of welfare
In Their Language	Every session is delivered in the language of the community. Every example, every use case, every outcome is rooted in their lived context — not an abstract or corporate framing.
Learn, Then Build	Theory without application fades. Every participant goes through a learning phase followed by a live building session, producing a real first product, solution, or workflow — in the room, on the day.

C. Three Target Groups

1. School Students (Class 9–12, SCBC)

Aspirational students at a critical juncture, ready to shape their futures if given the right tools

- Use AI to learn faster, understand concepts better, and score higher
- Discover scholarships, career opportunities, and competitive exam resources using AI
- Build income potential through freelancing and gig work facilitated by AI tools
- Develop a portfolio project they can present with pride

2. Women SHG Leaders (SCBC Women-Led SHGs)

- Use AI as a co-founder on their phones — accessible, voice-first, no English required
- Overcome barriers in marketing, customer communication, and sales using AI chatbots
- Explore new income streams and digital market access
- Target cohort: 20–30 women SHG leaders

3. Persons with Physical Disability

Individuals with disability often face compounded barriers to opportunity. AI can level that field.

- Use AI tools suited to their specific accessibility needs
- Build vocational or entrepreneurial skills using available infrastructure
- Demonstrate that disability is not a limit to building or leading
- Conducted at or near an existing vocational centre with basic digital access

D. Program Format

Duration	6 hours
Learning Phase	~2.5 hrs: AI fundamentals, tools, prompting, use cases — fully contextualized
Building Phase	~2.5 hrs: Participants build a real first solution, live, with hand-holding support
Closing	~1 hr: Demonstration and certification for all participants
Language	Delivered in the local language of participants; examples from their context
Device	Mobile first approach.
Prerequisite	Basic digital familiarity (has used a phone or computer); no coding required

E. Roles and requirements

What We Request from the Department	What Wasabi AI Brings
• A school with computer/internet facility and eligible Class 9–12 SCBC students(20-30 students) • Identification of 20–30 SHG women leaders (SCBC-led SHGs) • A vocational center with basic digital infrastructure for the disability cohort • All participants at digital Level 1 (basic phone or computer usage familiarity) • Infra requested: Computers, Training room, projector/screen, internet	• Full program delivery — facilitation, content, and instruction • Free AI tool subscriptions for all participants • Hand-holding support through the live building session • Certificates and recognition for all participants • A replicable, scalable model you can expand across Haryana

Note: We are not seeking any monetary partnership.

F. Outcomes

1. Community-Led Problem Identification: Once individuals have the tools and confidence to build, they begin articulating problems that no external researcher or policy team has ever surfaced. The most accurate, actionable problem statements for SCBC welfare will come from SCBC communities themselves — this program creates the conditions for that to happen.

2. A Shift in Self-Belief: Participants leave not just with skills, but with a fundamentally different perception of themselves. The experience of building something real — in their own language, on their own terms — triggers a psychological shift that no certificate or cash transfer can replicate. This confidence ripples outward into family, community, and peer networks.

3. An Accelerator Across Every Life Domain: AI is not a single skill — it is a force multiplier. A student uses it to study smarter and crack competitive exams. A woman entrepreneur uses it to market her business. A person with disability uses it to access opportunities previously out of reach. The same capability accelerates learning, skilling, employment, and enterprise — simultaneously.

4. A Demonstrable Portfolio, Not Just Attendance: Every participant leaves with something they built. Not a certificate of participation, but a tangible proof of creation — a solution, a tool, a workflow. This becomes the first entry in a professional portfolio that can open doors in ways a marksheet alone cannot.

5. A Replicable Model for the Department: This proof-of-concept is designed to be documented, measured, and scaled. The department gains a tested, ground-level playbook for AI-led empowerment that can be replicated across districts, target groups, and welfare schemes — without reinventing the wheel each time.

G. Why This Matters

Financial support empowers people for a season. The belief that "I can build, I can solve, I can lead for myself and others" empowers them for a lifetime. The most profound shift in welfare comes not from the outside in, but from the inside out. When an SCBC student builds their first AI-powered solution in a room full of peers — when a woman SHG leader sends her first AI-drafted marketing message in her own language — something changes permanently. That is the outcome we are here to create.